

FREE GUIDE FOR SCHOOL LEADERS

AI Readiness Checklist

Is your school ready to implement AI safely, ethically, and with confidence?

What this checklist covers:

- Staff awareness & understanding
- Governance & policy foundations
- Tool selection & data safety
- CPD & training readiness
- Ongoing oversight & review

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AI Readiness Checklist

Part 1 of 2 — Foundations, Governance & Tool Safety

How to use this checklist: Work through each section with your SLT. Tick items you have in place. Flag gaps as actions.

01 STAFF AWARENESS & UNDERSTANDING

☐ **All staff have received an introduction to AI**
Every member of staff — teaching and support — understands what generative AI is and what it is not.

☐ **Staff understand AI is not a search engine**
Staff know that AI generates responses rather than retrieving facts, and can hallucinate or produce errors.

☐ **Staff can identify AI-generated content**
There is a shared understanding of the indicators that content may have been AI-generated.

☐ **Ethical implications have been discussed**
Staff have had structured CPD discussing bias, accuracy, academic integrity and the limits of AI.

☐ **A clear acceptable use policy exists for staff**
Staff know which AI tools are approved, for what purposes, and what is explicitly prohibited.

02 GOVERNANCE & POLICY FOUNDATIONS

☐ **A school AI policy is in place**
A written, governor-approved policy sets out your school's approach to AI use, covering staff, pupils and data.

☐ **Policy references DfE generative AI guidance**
Your policy explicitly references the DfE's Generative AI: product safety expectations (January 2025).

☐ **KCSIE 2025 paragraph 143 has been reviewed**
Your DSL and SLT have read and actioned the KCSIE 2025 requirements around generative AI and filtering.

☐ **Governors have been briefed on AI**
Your governing body understands the school's approach to AI and has signed off the policy framework.

AI Readiness Checklist

Part 2 of 2 — Tool Safety, CPD & Ongoing Oversight

03 TOOL SELECTION & DATA SAFETY

☐

Only approved tools are in use across school

A defined list of approved AI tools exists. Staff are not using unapproved consumer tools with school data.

☐

Tools are within your school's data tenancy

AI tools in use are within your Microsoft 365 or Google Workspace tenancy, not open consumer platforms.

☐

Tools meet DfE product safety expectations

Each approved tool has been assessed against the DfE's filtering, logging, security and transparency standards.

☐

Your DPO has reviewed AI tool use

Your Data Protection Officer has assessed AI tools for GDPR compliance and data processing implications.

☐

Pupil data is never entered into unapproved AI

There is a clear rule — and staff awareness — that pupil-identifiable data must not be entered into any AI tool.

04 CPD & TRAINING READINESS

☐

CPD has been tailored by role

Teachers, support staff and leaders have received AI training relevant to their specific role and context.

☐

Staff feel confident — not fearful — about AI

A culture check: staff see AI as a tool to support them, not a threat or an unknown quantity.

☐

Pupil education on AI is planned or in place

There is a curriculum plan for teaching pupils about safe, critical and ethical engagement with AI.

05 ONGOING OVERSIGHT & REVIEW

☐

AI use is reviewed at least termly by SLT

Senior leaders regularly review how AI is being used across school and whether the policy remains fit for purpose.

What next?